

ECONOMICS

Week 08

Breakeven Analysis

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Break-Even Point Analysis

A decision-making aid that enables a manager to determine whether a particular volume of sales will result in **losses** or **profits**

Basic Concepts

Variable costs are costs that change with changes in production levels or sales.

Examples include: *Costs of materials used in the production of the goods*

Fixed costs remain roughly the same regardless of sales/output levels.

Examples include: *Rent, Insurance and Wages*

Revenue is the total income received.

Profit is the money you have after subtracting fixed and variable cost from revenue.

What it can be used for?

- Monthly expenses- use it to see if your income is more than your expenses
- Determine minimum price product can be sold for
- Determine optimum price product can be sold for
- Calculate effects of marketing programs on price

The Break-Even Point (BEP)

$$P(X) = F + V(X)$$

Revenue *Total Costs*

Where:

- F = fixed costs
- V = variable costs per unit
- X = volume of output (in units)
- P = price per unit

The Break-Even Point (BEP)

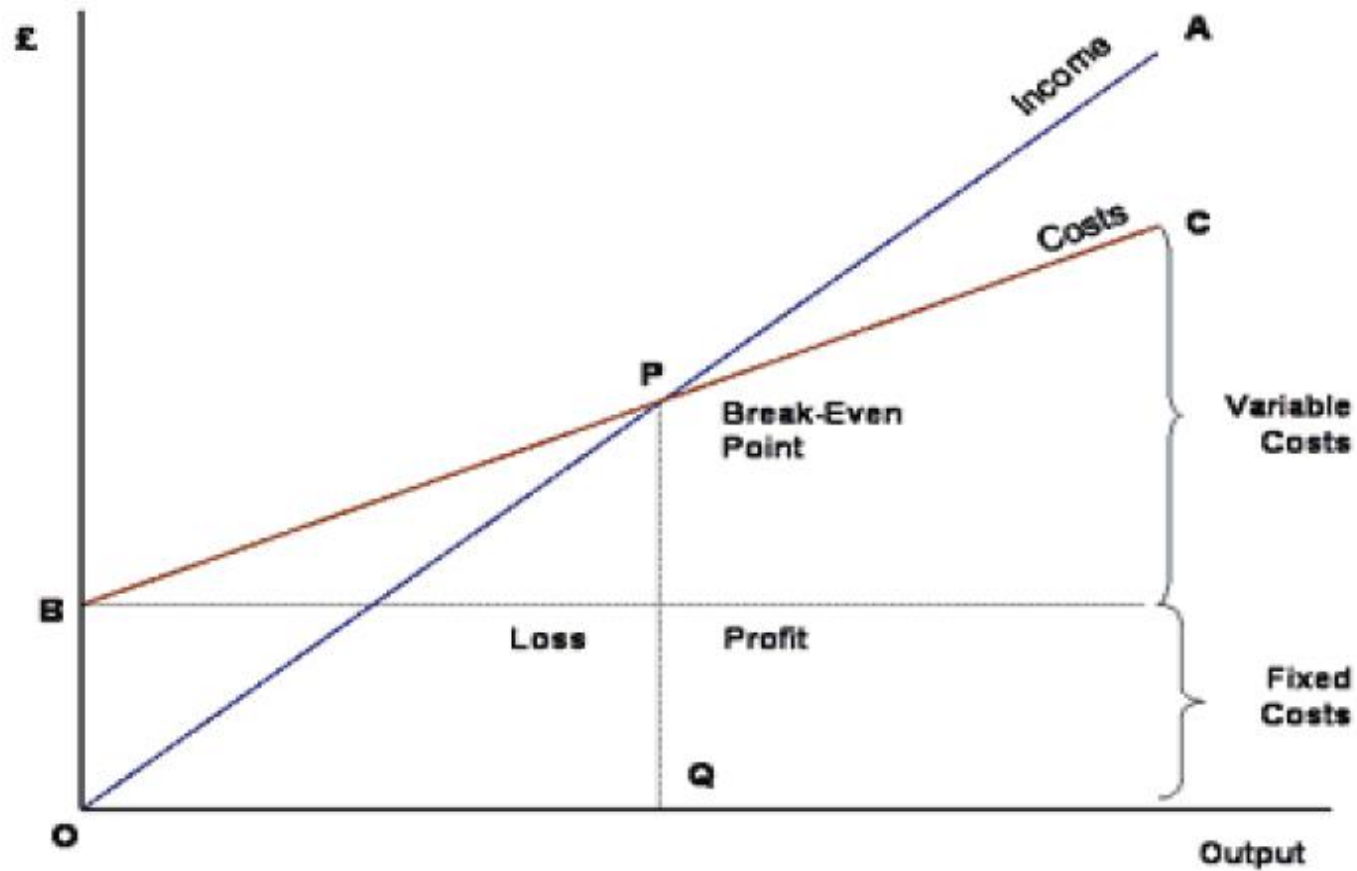
If we rearrange the formula where the breakeven is **X** then the formula look like this

$$\mathbf{X = F / (P - V)}$$


Break-Event Point

This formula says that the breakeven point is where the number of sales needed to make the cost equal to the revenue.

The Break-Even Point Chart



Sample Problem # 1

Lets say you own a business selling burgers

It costs **USD 7.00** to make one burger **That's your V or Variable cost!**

You sell each burger for **USD 12.50**.
That's your P or price per unit!

Your cost for rent, utilities, overhead, etc... is
USD 100,000 per month.
That's your F or fixed cost!

Sample Problem # 1 – Solution

Given:

$$V = \text{USD } 7, P = \text{USD } 12.50$$

$$F = \text{USD } 100,000$$

- Solution:
- $X = F / (P - V)$
- $X = 100,000 / (12.50 - 7) \quad X = 100,000 / (5.5)$
- $X = 18,181.818$
- $X \approx 18,182$

To breakeven you would need to sell **18182** burgers.

Sample Problem # 2

Try out this problem for your self

- You own a lemonade stand.
- It costs you **USD 1.50** to make cup of lemonade
- You sell your lemonade for **USD 5.00**.
- It cost you **USD5,000** to rent for the space of your lemonade stand.
- How many cups of lemonade do you have to sell to breakeven?

Solve now

Sample Problem # 2 – Solution

Given:

$$V = \text{USD } 1.50 \quad P = \text{USD } 5.00$$

$$F = \text{USD } 5,000$$

Solution:

$$X = F / (P - V)$$

$$X = 5000 / (5 - 1.50)$$

$$X = 5000 / (3.5)$$

$$X = 1,428.57$$

$$X \approx 1,429$$

You would need to sell 1,429 cups of lemonade to breakeven.

Limitations of BEP Analysis

- Assumes that sales prices are constant at all levels of output.
- Assumes production and sales are the same.
- Break even charts may be time consuming to prepare.
- It can only apply to a single product or single mix of products.

Conclusion

- A Breakeven Analysis is a simple tool to use to determine if you have priced your product correctly.
- A Breakeven Analysis helps you calculate how much you need to sell before you begin to make a profit. You can also see how fixed costs, price, volume, and other factors affect your net profit.